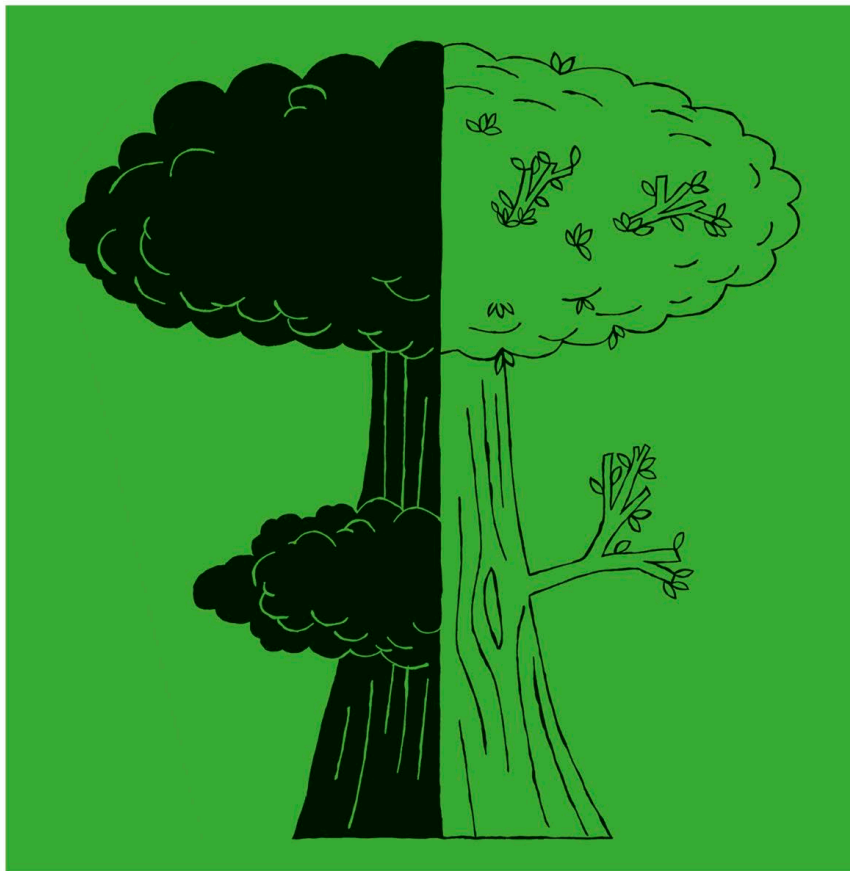


LET US STEP BACK FROM THE SHADOWS OF WAR

THE PARTIAL TEST BAN TREATY (1963)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Arms control

BEFORE

1945 The US drops atomic bombs on the Japanese cities of Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

1946 The UN Atomic Energy Commission (UNAEC) is created to address the risks of the use of atomic energy.

1952 The US carries out the first hydrogen bomb test.

1961 The USSR tests its Tsar Bomba, the most powerful hydrogen bomb ever tested.

AFTER

1998 India and Pakistan each test several atomic or hydrogen bombs in a race to become nuclear-armed states.

2006–2017 North Korea conducts six underground nuclear tests.

On August 5, 1963, the US, Soviet Union (USSR), and the UK signed the Partial, or Limited, Nuclear Test Ban Treaty (PTBT or LTBT). The treaty did not slow the nuclear arms race directly, but banned nuclear weapons tests in the atmosphere, underwater, or in outer space, marking a vital first step in control of nuclear weapons.

MAD arms race

In the 1950s, tensions escalated between the West and Soviet bloc during the Cold War. The US and USSR pursued a headlong nuclear arms race, driven in part by a game-theorist strategy of mutual assured destruction (MAD). On the